

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A8: Free Composition and Independent Research

Define an evaluable project, maintain a source-and-idiom ledger, and complete a supported first revised Latin draft without overstating portfolio maturity

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-A8
Course stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisites	EL-A7 and a passing guided composition with visible revision
Observable outcome	Define an evaluable project, maintain a source-and-idiom ledger, and complete a supported first revised Latin draft without overstating portfolio maturity
Printed practice	Worksheets IV.29 (composition proposal, Variant A) and IV.30 (source and idiom ledger, Variant B), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets IV.31 and IV.32 remain optional rehearsal for the independent reading dossier and final portfolio audit
Next dependency	EL-GATE-IV, Advanced Reading and Composition Assessment Sequence (A-A and delayed A-B); no graduation claim before passage

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Define scope, register, evidence, and success criteria in Worksheet IV.29; begin the source-and-idiom ledger in Worksheet IV.30.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Produce and revise a 150–250-word project-composed first draft, then audit every borrowed phrase, construction, and unresolved decision against that ledger.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Submit a bounded proposal, complete source/idiom ledger, and first revised 150–250-word Latin draft scoring at least 3 in every applicable rubric category, while marking unresolved choices and making no final-independence claim.

Course boundary. The two-session deliverable is a proposal and supported first revised draft. A mature portfolio, unfamiliar-Mass dossier, delayed revision, and defense are tested by EL-GATE-IV; Worksheets IV.31 and IV.32 remain optional rehearsal rather than hidden required pages.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- bounded research question, declared register, audience, proposition plan, and success criterion;
- source phrase, construction model, adaptation, and independent choice;
- first draft, three-pass revision, unresolved decision, and escalation; and
- portfolio evidence distinguished from a final claim of independence.

2.2 High-risk contrast

Free composition removes supplied sentence frames, not the obligation to plan, document, check, and revise. A first supported draft is a module outcome; independence is a delayed portfolio judgment.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A8. Free composition and independent research

Free composition is not support-free composition. Advanced writers still use grammars, dictionaries, corpora, models, revision, and informed readers. What becomes free is the choice and organization of content.

Free composition is composition in which the writer chooses and organizes the propositions and principal structures rather than completing a supplied frame. It remains accountable to evidence and revision. A **corpus** is a defined body of texts searched or compared as evidence for usage; it is not automatically representative merely because it is large. An **attested construction** is one actually documented in a relevant source, though one occurrence alone may not prove that it suits every context.

On completing this unit, you can:

- design and complete an original ecclesiastical prose project;
- maintain a source and idiom ledger;
- write a grammatical-literary commentary on an unfamiliar proper; and
- assess limitations without retreating to a facing translation.

1.1 The composition portfolio

A **portfolio** is a curated body of work selected to demonstrate range, development, and final competence; it includes drafts and rationale, not only clean products. A **source ledger** records borrowed wording and its exact location. An **idiom ledger** records a construction, its contextual sense, and a relevant attestation so that evidence can be reused without severing it from context.

Complete at least four different pieces:

1. a 150–250 word narrative or meditation;
2. a 150–250 word expository commentary;
3. two short collect-shaped composition exercises with different architectures; and
4. a revised piece chosen by the learner, accompanied by all drafts and a defense of ten grammatical or lexical decisions.

For every borrowed phrase, record the source. For every unusual construction, record a grammar section or credible parallel. This is scholarly hygiene, not an admission that the writing is not free.

1.2 The independent reading dossier

A **dossier** is an organized packet of evidence and analysis directed to one inquiry. Unlike a portfolio, which demonstrates a writer's development across pieces, this reading dossier assembles the textual, grammatical, allusive, rhetorical, and register evidence needed to explain one formulary.

Choose an unfamiliar Mass from the universal 1962 calendar. Without a facing translation:

- read every text and mark only genuine lookups;
- prepare a clause map for the most difficult prayer and lesson sentence;
- trace three secure allusions with context;

- write one rhetorical note and one register note;
- summarize the linguistic unity or contrast of the formulary; and
- list remaining uncertainties with proposed ways to resolve them.

1.3 Final standard

Fluency does not mean instant recall of every rare lemma. It means that forms and ordinary syntax are transparent enough for attention to rest on argument, image, source, and style. A dictionary lookup should add a word, not assemble the sentence on the learner's behalf.

Here **fluency** means reliable, increasingly automatic access to ordinary forms, constructions, and discourse relations during reading and writing. It is compatible with deliberate analysis of a difficult period and consultation for a rare word. **Independence** means that those aids refine or verify a proposed reading rather than supply the grammatical structure the learner cannot yet see.

Advance when: complete the composition portfolio and independent reading dossier; then read a second unfamiliar complete Mass under assessment conditions, with no English translation and only a dictionary for genuinely unknown words. Explain the Latin directly and defend selected analyses.

CHAPTER 2

Advanced composition rubric

Score each category from 0 to 4. A piece is ready for the portfolio at 3 or 4 in every category; a high total cannot conceal a structural failure.

A **rubric** is a scoring instrument that defines separate dimensions of performance and describes evidence at each level. Here **morphology** scores the forms produced; **syntax** scores their dependencies; **lexicon** scores contextual word choice; **cohesion** scores relations across clauses and sentences; **register** scores consistency with the chosen language model; **rhetoric** scores arrangement in service of thought; **documentation** scores traceability of evidence; and **revision** scores principled improvement across drafts. The categories overlap in actual prose, but each diagnoses a different kind of strength or failure.

Category	4: independent	3: sound	2 or below: revise
Morphology	accurate throughout; any rare form defensible	isolated slip, no repeated pattern	repeated or meaning-changing form errors
Syntax	relations clear, varied, idiomatic, controlled	sound core with limited awkwardness	English calques, broken government/sequence, or ambiguous spine
Lexicon	precise contextual senses and attested constructions	generally apt with minor repetition	first-gloss substitutions or anachronistic sense
Cohesion	explicit logical movement and stable reference	readable sequence with occasional rough join	sentence pile without controlled relation
Register	consistent chosen ecclesiastical model	mostly consistent	accidental mixture or unsupported imitation
Rhetoric	arrangement serves thought without display	some effective balance/repetition	labels or ornament disconnected from meaning
Documentation	all borrowed language and disputed choices traceable	small citation gaps	patchwriting or unverifiable claims
Revision	drafts show principled structural and stylistic decisions	errors corrected with explanation	clean copy only or unexplained replacement

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 The composition portfolio — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A portfolio is evidence of decisions over time, not a clean final text detached from its process.

Transfer task. Assemble proposal, proposition plan, first draft, correction layer, source ledger, revised draft, rubric, and unresolved list in that order.

Retrieval check. Identify which artifact proves that a polished sentence was revised rather than copied.

1.2 The independent reading dossier — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Reading evidence must remain independent from the composition's chosen source material.

Transfer task. Design the later Worksheet IV.31 dossier now: blind heading selection, exposure declaration, cold map, lookup ledger, direct summary, difficult-form notes, and residual uncertainties. Do not complete it in this sitting.

Retrieval check. State why a text mined for the composition cannot serve as blind reading evidence.

1.3 Final standard — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Graduation is a defensible judgment across reading, research, composition, and delayed revision, not the completion date of one packet.

Transfer task. Score the first revised draft provisionally, marking each category as demonstrated, not yet demonstrated, or outside this packet. Prescribe one next evidence event for every incomplete category.

Retrieval check. Write a one-sentence claim that accurately describes the current milestone without claiming independence.

1.4 Worked proposal-to-draft process — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A strong free project narrows choices before prose expands.

Transfer task. Create a project-composed model packet: one-sentence aim, six propositions, declared register, three checked construction models, 150–250-word draft, and three-pass change log.

Retrieval check. For each model, distinguish borrowed phrase from abstract construction.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

A8 worksheet family: independent work

Worksheet IV.29 — Composition proposal

Worksheet ID: IV.29

Focus: Define a free project that can be evaluated.

Use: Complete before drafting the portfolio piece.

1. State audience, register, genre, and length.

-
2. List four propositions the piece must communicate.

-
3. Name two authentic prose models and what each contributes.

-
4. Set a limit on borrowed strings.

-
5. Draft a structural outline in Latin headings and clause frames.
-

Worksheet IV.30 — Source and idiom ledger

Worksheet ID: IV.30

Focus: Make advanced support visible.

Use: Keep beside every free draft.

1. Record five borrowed or closely imitated phrases with exact sources.

-
2. Record five disputed word choices.

-
3. Record three complex syntactic choices.

-
4. When does a source ledger reveal patchwriting?

-
5. How should patchwriting be revised?
-

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

The composition portfolio — model and rubric

Connection. A portfolio is evidence of decisions over time, not a clean final text detached from its process.

Model / acceptable evidence. The marked first draft and dated correction layer show revision; the source ledger distinguishes borrowed wording and modeled construction. A clean final alone cannot prove process.

The independent reading dossier — model and rubric

Connection. Reading evidence must remain independent from the composition's chosen source material.

Model / acceptable evidence. The design keeps the dossier's selection and cold record separate from composition research. Prior mining changes exposure and must be disclosed; it may support study but not blind transfer.

Final standard — model and rubric

Connection. Graduation is a defensible judgment across reading, research, composition, and delayed revision, not the completion date of one packet.

Model / acceptable evidence. A valid claim is limited to a bounded proposal and supported first revised draft. Independent reading, delayed retention, final portfolio audit, and defense remain explicitly outstanding.

Worked proposal-to-draft process — model and rubric

Connection. A strong free project narrows choices before prose expands.

Model / acceptable evidence. The model labels all new Latin project-composed, cites every borrowed phrase, describes abstract syntax without claiming ownership of wording, and records at least one substantive revision in skeleton, concord, and idiom.

CHAPTER 3

A8 worksheet family: independent work

Solution IV.29 — Composition proposal

Worksheet ID: IV.29

Focus: Define a free project that can be evaluated.

Use: Complete before drafting the portfolio piece.

1. State audience, register, genre, and length.

Answer / model: Model: “An advanced Latin reader; Vulgate-influenced expository prose; meditation; 180–220 words.” Specific answers vary.

2. List four propositions the piece must communicate.

Answer / model: Answers vary; each should be content, not an English sentence to translate.

3. Name two authentic prose models and what each contributes.

Answer / model: Provide exact citations and a feature such as relative architecture, connective logic, or vocabulary—not merely an author name.

4. Set a limit on borrowed strings.

Answer / model: Model policy: quote only deliberately and cite; otherwise imitate construction with new vocabulary; maintain a phrase ledger.

5. Draft a structural outline in Latin headings and clause frames.

Answer / model: A sound outline assigns a grammatical architecture to each proposition and identifies likely transitions.

Solution IV.30 — Source and idiom ledger

Worksheet ID: IV.30

Focus: Make advanced support visible.

Use: Keep beside every free draft.

1. Record five borrowed or closely imitated phrases with exact sources.

Answer / model: For each: source, exact borrowed words, grammatical adaptation, and purpose in the new text.

2. Record five disputed word choices.

Answer / model: For each: lemma, sense, construction, dictionary/corpus evidence, rejected alternative.

3. Record three complex syntactic choices.

Answer / model: For each: clause type, sequence/government, model or grammar reference, and final verification.

4. When does a source ledger reveal patchwriting?

Answer / model: When borrowed strings carry the prose without an independently planned syntax or argument, or when citations are omitted and transitions are uncontrolled.

5. How should patchwriting be revised?

Answer / model: Return to propositions, rebuild the sentence architecture independently, retain only deliberate quotation, and document genuine imitation.

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A8, *Free Composition and Independent Research*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. The packet deliberately stops at proposal and supported first revision. The separate EL-GATE-IV companion supplies the required independent dossier and final-audit evidence.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course’s controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See’s Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every

historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; **unexposed:** exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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